

Allied Health Professionals

A Nutrition Coach (NC) can provide a valuable service in the mission to keep clients healthy while avoiding chronic disease and disability.

There are many opportunities for a Nutrition Coach to work with any number of allied health professionals who are part of the continuum of care. Most healthcare providers have little training or experience in the field of nutrition; for this reason, the Nutrition Coach can become an asset for many of these professionals.

Registered Dietitian Nutritionist (RDN)

RDN is a "legally protected designation" and exclusive property of the Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics.



A Nutritional Coach should not try to compete with an RDN but could work in conjunction with this licensed healthcare.

Certified Personal Trainer (CPT)

A CPT designation allows the trainer to work with general, healthy populations.



The CPT and the NC can provide a cohesive team approach that will ultimately benefit the client.

Athletic trainers, Certified (ATC)

An ATC is a trainer who specifically works with athletes to improve performance, prevent and treat injury.



The NC could play an integral role in an athlete's recovery and overall performance.

Physicians (MD, DO)

Most common being Doctors of Medicine (MD), Doctors of Osteopathy (DO).



Physicians can collaborate with Nutrition Coaches to reinforce non-medical-nutrition-therapy based treatment plans related to patients' goals and compliance.

Registered Nurses (RN) or Advanced Registered Nurse Practitioner (ARNP)



The office nurse can be a valuable referral tool for the Nutritional Coach.

Chiropractors (DC)

A Doctor of Chiropractic Medicine



A Nutritional Coach may be part of the office treatment team or can be used on a referral basis.

Physical Therapists (PT)

A physical therapist also has a college degree and is licensed by their state.



A Nutritional Coach can be a tremendous asset to a physical therapy clinic or rehabilitation facility.

Certified Eating Disorders Specialist (CEDS)

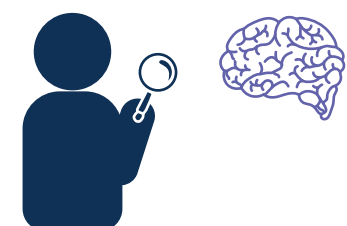
Those who specialize in working with patients suffering with eating disorders practice various forms of psychotherapy.



It is important to note that if a Nutrition Coach suspects that a client has an eating disorder, he or she must refer this client to a specialist for treatment.

Psychiatrist/Psychologist

These mental health practitioners work in the diagnosis and treatment of mental disorders.



Nutrition guidance should come from an RDN, but a Nutrition Coach could certainly support the RDN's plan to best assist the patient.

Any type of medical nutrition therapy should be referred out to a Registered Dietitian Nutritionist. When formal referrals are made to a Nutrition Coach, it is important for the NC to provide regular progress reports and immediately notify referring provider of any setbacks or medical emergencies. The Nutrition Coach is qualified to work with healthy clients with minimal health risks, whereas a Registered Dietitian Nutritionist has extensive training and education around specific medical situations. Those patients with multiple risk factors or advanced stages of disease or dysfunction should be referred to a Registered Dietitian Nutritionist who specialize in the respective areas that seek attention.